

Chapter 83 - Psycho

Tamana Mountain Ski Resort was Vancouver's largest skiing destination, with the most ski trails. The developed ski area occupied 70% of the mountain, while the undeveloped backcountry made up 30% - it was an adventurer's paradise.

Naturally, Feng Yue's group of four wouldn't be going to the backcountry, since Feng Yue could only manage basic standing and gliding on skis.

At the foot of Tamana Mountain was also a large resort village with everything needed for eating, drinking, entertainment, and accommodation. Their hotel was located here.

This time there was no issue of who would room with whom - everyone had their own room. Four rooms, two on each side with a hallway in between.

When choosing rooms, Jiang Zhao let their "guest" Yan Lin choose first, then Jiang Ming eagerly handed the keycard for the room diagonally across from Yan Lin's to Feng Yue.

Feng Yue naturally didn't say much, just silently accepted the keycard. Yan Lin stood behind the three of them clutching her keycard, her eyes downcast, not knowing what she was thinking.

None of the four had much luggage since they were only staying two nights. They arrived fairly late, so Jiang Zhao suggested everyone return to their rooms to rest before coming down for dinner.

Yan Lin walked at the back, watching Feng Yue return to her room and close the door before she herself gripped her keycard and touched her room's door handle.

Jiang Zhao was staying next door to her. Seeing Yan Lin's poor complexion, he naturally knew she was probably upset about Jiang Ming's behavior just now.

"Miss Yan, sorry about that. Jiang Ming didn't mean any harm."

Yan Lin lowered her head, her curled lashes hiding the emotions in her eyes. She shook her head without speaking, then opened her door and went inside.

Jiang Zhao looked at the empty hallway and couldn't tell whether this trip would be fortunate or unfortunate for Yan Lin.

A subtle sigh dissipated in the deserted corridor.

Yan Lin returned to her room and threw herself onto the soft bed, closing her eyes tightly as she replayed the scene of Feng Yue turning around and closing the door without mercy.

A fine, dense pain gradually spread through her heart.

She kept chasing after Feng Yue, thinking she could reach out and grasp the hem of her clothes, only to come up empty the next second.

Yan Lin no longer knew what she should do. All she could manage now was to try hard to keep up with Feng Yue's footsteps, to try not to let her disappear from her sight.

Even though there was a chasm-like gulf between them.

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After the four had rested for a while, Jiang Zhao saw it was about time and got up first to knock on everyone's doors. Once all four had gathered, they went downstairs to find food.

The four found seats in the hotel restaurant, and a server brought menus. Jiang Ming and Feng Yue were ordering, but Jiang Ming hadn't looked at the menu long before she received a phone call and left the restaurant.

When she returned, there was a tall European woman standing beside her.

Feng Yue was clearly stunned when she saw her, then broke into a smile.

"Dana! Long time no see."

Yes, the newcomer was none other than one of the friends Jiang Ming had introduced to Feng Yue - that woman who worked at the botanical garden and was full of academic atmosphere: Dana.

As Jiang Ming's friend, Dana naturally knew Jiang Zhao, so after greeting Feng Yue and Jiang Zhao, her gaze fell on the only stranger present - Yan Lin.

When Dana saw Yan Lin's face, she couldn't help but exclaim: "This lady is so beautiful! Are all women from your China such beauties?"

Although Dana's words were somewhat exaggerated, no one present would deny the fact that Yan Lin was beautiful.

However, Yan Lin was unmoved by Dana's praise. Having grown up hearing such words, she was more concerned about what kind of relationship this woman named Dana might have with Feng Yue.

Dana's curiosity about Yan Lin lasted only a moment. At Jiang Ming's invitation, she sat down at their table.

"Dana, how did you end up here? Are you also here with friends?" Feng Yue asked with sparkling eyes and a smile.

Dana had a good impression of her friend's rose-loving¹ cousin, so she tossed her hair and replied: "Indeed, a friend invited me, but that friend is Catherine."

Dana's words left the three present stunned for a moment, though all three knew perfectly well why Jiang Ming had done this.

Feng Yue felt somewhat helpless. She thought Jiang Ming had given up on that idea, but apparently she had just been biding her time.

However, she didn't avoid Dana awkwardly, because she could see that the other person probably only had ordinary friendship feelings toward her. They might be closer because of shared interests, but there definitely wasn't anything deeper.

But probably only she herself thought this way.

During dinner, Yan Lin remained silent throughout, while Jiang Ming, Dana, and Feng Yue chatted happily.

Yan Lin watched this scene, her eyes red with jealousy.

At one point, Feng Yue got up to go to the restroom. She had barely left when Yan Lin silently followed.

Jiang Ming's expression changed, and she immediately wanted to stand up and stop her, but Jiang Zhao pressed her down in her chair and tapped her plate: "Eat properly."

Yan Lin walked very quickly, so Jiang Ming's delay meant she naturally couldn't catch up.

Jiang Ming pouted and glared viciously at Jiang Zhao. Looking at his troublesome sister, Jiang Zhao could only sigh helplessly.

Dana, sitting nearby, looked completely confused, having no idea what was happening.

Meanwhile, Feng Yue had used the restroom and come out to wash her hands, only to see Yan Lin waiting in the hallway outside the restroom.

Feng Yue had finished washing her hands but hadn't yet had time to take out tissues from her bag when she saw Yan Lin walking straight toward her.

Yan Lin saw Feng Yue's fingers still dripping with water, thought for a moment, then took out a handkerchief from her bag and grasped Feng Yue's left hand with one hand.

Feng Yue was completely bewildered by this action, standing stunned for two full seconds before reacting. She yanked her hand forcefully, but couldn't pull free.

"What are you doing?!"

Yan Lin gripped Feng Yue's wrist with one hand, her head lowered and voice hoarse: "Don't move."

Speaking thus, she covered Feng Yue's hand with the light blue handkerchief embroidered with silver thread.

The cotton handkerchief was exceptionally soft, and under Yan Lin's use, it gently caressed every part of Feng Yue's fingers - palm, fingers, fingertips, between fingers.

Yan Lin wiped carefully and gently, but looking at the crown of her head exposed by her lowered position, Feng Yue inexplicably had the illusion that Yan Lin was unhappy.

When Yan Lin finished with the left hand and let go, wanting to wipe the right hand, Feng Yue didn't give her another chance.

She quickly stepped back, creating distance from Yan Lin, then looked warily at the person before her, frowning as she demanded: "Yan Lin, what exactly are you trying to do?"

Yan Lin's body stiffened at Feng Yue's movement, then she silently folded the handkerchief and put it back in her pocket.

She looked up, those dark eyes like a deep, bottomless pool of still water, her tone carrying undisguised humility: "Ah Yue... do you, do you like that woman?"

They both knew clearly who this "woman" referred to.

Yan Lin's cautious and anxious inquiry - she seemed very afraid of making Feng Yue angry but was also very concerned about this matter, which was why she had asked.

But when Feng Yue heard this question, her expression suddenly darkened. Her beautiful eyes blazed with anger as she stared at Yan Lin: "Yan Lin, if you're sick then go get treatment. Don't act crazy in front of me! Just because someone appears around me, do I have to fall in love with them? Am I some lovesick fool who can't live without romance in your eyes?!"

Yan Lin hadn't expected this question would completely set Feng Yue off. She stood there helplessly, wanting to step forward and explain something, when she heard Feng Yue continue: "Don't imagine me and my friends in such a despicable way."

After saying this, Feng Yue took a few steps around Yan Lin and headed back to the restaurant with a dark expression.

Yan Lin stood alone in place for quite a while, until passing guests gave her strange looks, and only then did she compose herself and leave.

It was okay, as long as Ah Yue didn't like that person, everything was still salvageable. Being scolded didn't matter, being rejected didn't matter - as long as Ah Yue hadn't fallen in love with someone else, that was good enough...

Feng Yue returned to the restaurant fuming with anger. Jiang Ming immediately asked: "Xiao Yue, what's wrong? Why are you so angry?"

Feng Yue sat down and drank some water: "Nothing, just ran into a psycho²."

"Are you okay?" Jiang Zhao thought she had encountered some drunk or something.

Feng Yue calmed her emotions a bit and shook her head: "I'm fine, just a little angry."

Seeing she indeed wasn't hurt, the siblings both breathed sighs of relief.

At this point, Dana looked behind her and asked: "Didn't you run into your friend? She seemed to go looking for you, but you didn't come back together?"

The friend Dana was referring to was Yan Lin.

Feng Yue paused in her drinking, then said: "Didn't see her."

"Then let's wait a bit longer for Miss Yan. She probably went to use the restroom too."

Jiang Zhao probably guessed that something unpleasant had happened between the two and gave Feng Yue a way out.

Sure enough, Feng Yue just nodded silently without saying more.

Since she had personally agreed to bring Yan Lin along, there was no reason to just abandon her here, even though Yan Lin had indeed made her angry.

Before long, Yan Lin returned, her expression as cold and distant as always.

"Yan, Luna³ said you two didn't meet. Weren't you going to find her?" Dana asked directly when she saw her return.

Hearing this, Yan Lin was first stunned, then looked toward Feng Yue. Seeing the faint displeasure in Feng Yue's eyes, she nodded: "I went to the restroom and didn't encounter her."

"Ah, this hotel is quite large then."

Of the three outsiders present, probably only Dana believed these two's lies.

The Jiang Zhao and Jiang Ming siblings had more or less guessed that the "psycho" Feng Yue mentioned referred to Yan Lin.

Afraid the two might create more conflict staying here, Jiang Zhao suggested heading to the ski resort early, and the other four readily agreed.

Footnotes:

¹ Rose-loving (喜欢月季): This refers to Dana remembering that Feng Yue likes roses. "Yue" (月) in Feng Yue's name is part of the word for rose (月季 - yuèjì).

² Psycho (神经病): Literally "nerve disease" or "mental illness," this is a common Chinese slang term meaning "crazy person" or "psycho," often used as an insult.

³ Luna: Dana appears to be calling Feng Yue "Luna" here, which might be a nickname or her English name, relating to "Yue" (月) meaning "moon."